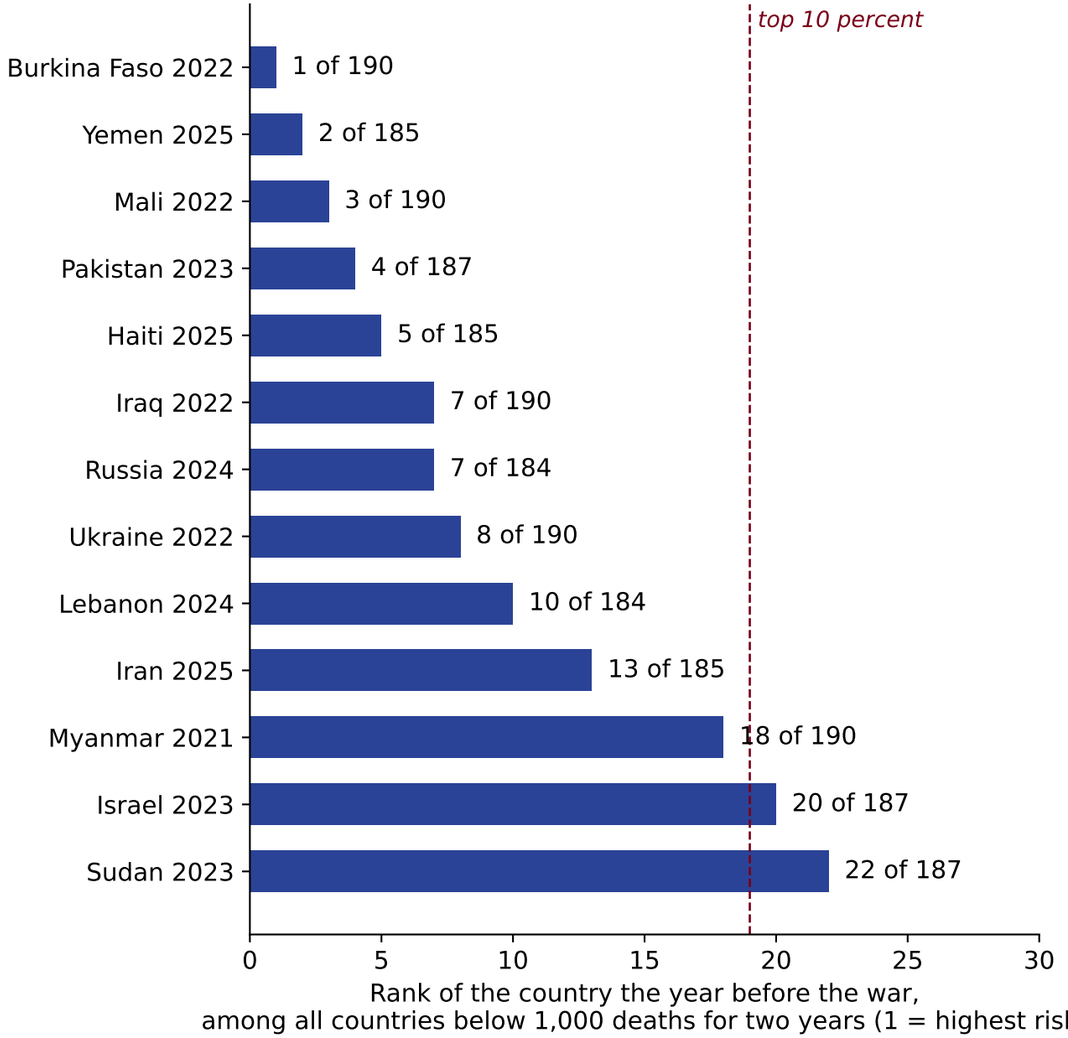
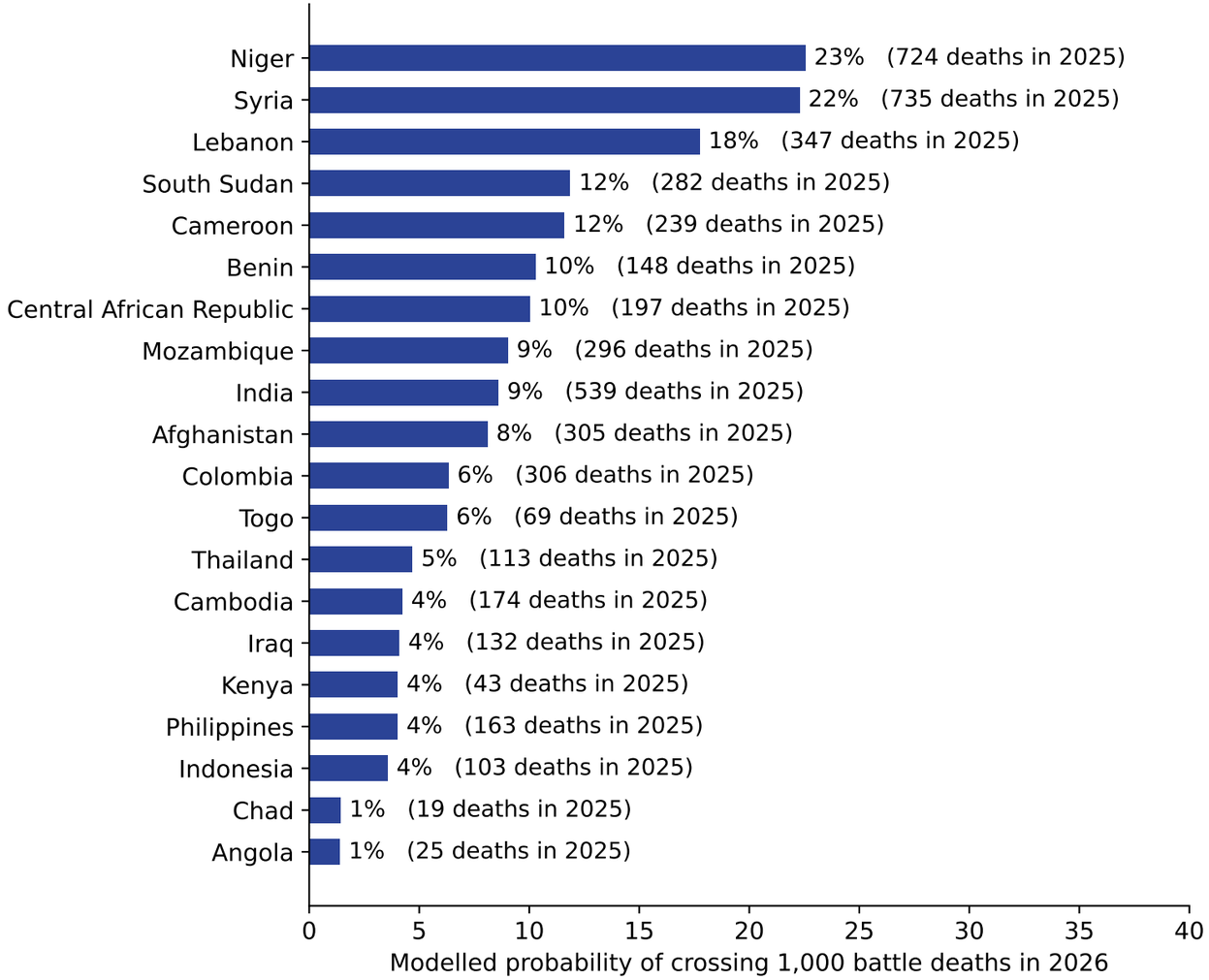
What the fitted model assesses and what it predicts

Escalation model: conflict history since 1946 and battle deaths in the two prior years, fitted on 1991–2020 (UCDP 26.1; UCDP/PRIO ACD 26.1).
Panel A is out of sample. Panel B is a forecast made in September 2026 and can be checked in 2027.

A. The 13 wars of 2021–2025: where the model ranked them the year before



B. The same model applied to 2025 data: countries with active violence, ranked for 2026



Countries already above 1,000 deaths in 2025 are left out of Panel B. The claim is the ranking; the percentages are uncalibrated model outputs.
Among countries with 25 to 499 deaths in a year, 3 to 7 percent cross 1,000 the next year.